

Exodus(TM) Frequently Asked Questions
Compiled by Mark L. Gottlieb
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Exodus booster packs, tournament packs, and theme decks go on sale in the _Magic Online_(TM) store at 9 a.m. (PST) on Monday, December 7, 2009.

The _Exodus_ set becomes legal for play in Classic, Classic (Vanguard), Commander, Freeform, Pauper, Prismatic, Singleton, Tempest Block Constructed, and Tribal Wars (Classic) formats on the day it goes on sale.

Exodus release events begin on Wednesday, December 9, 2009.

The _Exodus_ expansion, originally released in 1998, is a 143-card, black-bordered set featuring 44 rares, 44 uncommons, and 55 commons. The _Exodus_ set is nonredeemable. Online cards from the _Exodus_ set can't be exchanged for physical _Exodus_ cards.

This FAQ has two sections, each of which serves a different purpose.

The first section ("General Notes") explains the new mechanics and concepts in the set. The second section ("Card-Specific Notes") contains answers to the most important questions players might ask about a given card.

Items in the "Card-Specific Notes" section include full rules text for your reference. Not all cards in the set are listed.

GENERAL NOTES

Info: Rules Changes

The rules of the _Magic_(TM) game have evolved over the years since the _Exodus_ set was originally released. Many card wordings, including creature types, have also significantly changed. Most _Exodus_ cards have been reworded in the Oracle card reference, which contains up-to-date text for all tournament-legal cards. Although the rules team has done its best to maintain cards' functionality, some changes are inevitable.

The _Exodus_ set introduces no new keywords. It contains many keywords, themes, and mechanics that were introduced in the _Tempest_(TM) and _Stronghold_(TM) sets, however.

For information on the following topics, please see the _Tempest_ FAQ (http://www.wizards.com/dci/downloads/Tempest_FAQ_EN.doc):

Buyback
Shadow
Licids

For information on the following topic, please see the _Stronghold_ FAQ

(http://www.wizards.com/dci/downloads/MTGST_FAQ_02242009.rtf):

Spikes

Cycle: Keepers

This set has a cycle of creatures with "Keeper" in their names. Each one has an ability that can be activated only if an opponent is ahead of you in some aspect of the game.

Keeper of the Light

{W}{W}

Creature -- Human Wizard

1/2

{W}, {T}: Choose target opponent who had more life than you did as you activated this ability. You gain 3 life.

* Each Keeper has an activated ability that targets an opponent who meets a certain comparative condition as the ability is activated. For example, Keeper of the Light's activated ability targets an opponent who, at the time the ability is activated, has more life than you do.

* Whether the target is legal is checked as the target is chosen (when the ability is activated). You must target an opponent for whom the condition is true. If there isn't one, the ability can't be activated.

* Whether the target is legal is also checked at the time the ability resolves. The targeted player must still be in the game and must still be your opponent for the ability to resolve. However, the condition looks back at what the game state was at the time the ability was activated, and that can't change. All that matters is if it was true at the time the ability was activated. For example, Keeper of the Light's activated ability will resolve even if the targeted opponent's life total is now less than or equal to yours.

* Some of the Keepers' abilities don't affect the player they target. They target a player only to perform the comparison.

Cycle: Oaths

This set has a cycle of enchantments with "Oath" in their names. Each one has a triggered ability that can help the active player (the player whose turn it is) only if one of that player's opponents is ahead of him or her in some aspect of the game.

Oath of Lieges

{1}{W}

Enchantment

At the beginning of each player's upkeep, that player chooses target player who controls more lands than he or she does and is his or her opponent. The first player may search his or her library for a basic land card, put that card onto the battlefield, then shuffle his or her library.

* Each Oath has an ability that triggers at the beginning of each player's upkeep.

* The ability is controlled by the player who controlled the Oath at the time the ability triggered.

* However, the player whose turn it is (and who thus caused the ability to trigger) is the one who chooses the target. The target must be an opponent of that player, and something about the target and the active player is compared. For example, Oath of Lieges compares the number of lands controlled by the targeted player with the number of lands controlled by the player whose turn it is.

* Whether the comparison is true is checked both as the target is chosen (when the ability triggers) and as the ability resolves. Unlike the Keeper cycle, the condition looks at the current game state each time. For example, Oath of Lieges's triggered ability won't resolve if the number of lands the targeted player controls is now less than or equal to the number of lands controlled by the player whose turn it is.

* The ability of each Oath causes the player whose turn it is (not the controller of the ability or the targeted opponent) to perform an action.

* Some of the Oaths' abilities don't affect the player they target. They target a player only to perform the comparison.

* In a Two-Headed Giant game, an Oath's ability triggers twice each turn -- once per player on the team whose turn it is. The player who controls the Oath decides which of those abilities will resolve first.

Theme: Discarding a card at random as a cost

This set has a number of cards that have you discard a card at random as a cost.

Ogre Shaman

{3}{R}{R}

Creature -- Ogre Shaman

3/3

{2}, Discard a card at random: Ogre Shaman deals 2 damage to target creature or player.

* The cost that includes a random discard may be an activation cost of an ability (as on Ogre Shaman), a buyback cost, or another kind of additional cost.

* If the spell or activated ability targets something, you choose the target before you see which card you discard at random.

* While casting a spell or activating an ability, you activate mana abilities before you pay costs. You can't wait to see what card you discard and then activate mana abilities.

* If you're casting a spell with a random discard as a cost, you can't discard the card that is the spell you're casting. By the time you

would pay that cost, that card is on the stack, not in your hand. That means that if the last card in your hand is a spell with such a cost, you can't legally cast it.

Theme: Abilities that trigger whenever a player casts a spell

This set has a number of permanents with abilities that trigger whenever a player casts a spell. Some check only for specific types of spells, such as creature spells.

Spellshock

{2}{R}

Enchantment

Whenever a player casts a spell, Spellshock deals 2 damage to that player.

* Since the ability triggers when a player casts a spell, it is put on the stack on top of that spell and will resolve before it.

* If the ability targets a permanent, you can't target the permanent that spell becomes since it's not on the battlefield yet.

* Some of these abilities trigger whenever you cast a spell, some trigger whenever an opponent casts a spell, and some trigger whenever a player (including you) casts a spell. Be sure to read each trigger condition carefully.

* Such abilities don't trigger until all steps in the process of casting a spell have been completed. If a permanent with such an ability is sacrificed as part of casting a spell (due to an additional cost or a mana ability, for example), the ability won't trigger for that spell.

CARD-SPECIFIC NOTES

Æther Tide

{X}{U}

Sorcery

As an additional cost to cast Æther Tide, discard X creature cards. Return X target creatures to their owners' hands.

* All X's on a card have the same value. The maximum value of X as you cast Æther Tide is the amount of mana you can spend on it, the number of creature cards in your hand, or the number of creatures on the battlefield you can target, whichever is smallest.

Avenging Druid

{2}{G}

Creature -- Human Druid

1/3

Whenever Avenging Druid deals damage to an opponent, you may reveal cards from the top of your library until you reveal a land card. If you do, put that card onto the battlefield and put all other cards revealed this way into your graveyard.

* If you choose to reveal cards from the top of your library as the triggered ability resolves, but there are no land cards left in your library, you'll reveal your entire library and put all of those cards into your graveyard.

Bequeathal

{G}

Enchantment -- Aura

Enchant creature

When enchanted creature is put into a graveyard, you draw two cards.

* The controller of the triggered ability (not the controller of the enchanted creature) draws two cards when it resolves. The player who controls the ability is the player who controlled Bequeathal at the time it triggered.

Cataclysm

{2}{W}{W}

Sorcery

Each player chooses from the permanents he or she controls an artifact, a creature, an enchantment, and a land, then sacrifices the rest.

* Players don't choose permanents until Cataclysm resolves. Once a player chooses his or her permanents, it's too late for anyone to respond.

* First the player whose turn it is chooses his or her permanents. Then each other player in turn order does the same. Then all permanents not chosen this way are sacrificed simultaneously.

* A permanent with more than one card type may be chosen as any of its card types. For example, an artifact creature may be the artifact its controller chooses, or it may be the creature its controller chooses. It may even be chosen as both, though choosing it the second time has no benefit.

* If a player doesn't control a permanent of any of the four listed card types, that player simply doesn't choose a permanent for that type.

Coat of Arms

{5}

Artifact

Each creature gets +1/+1 for each other creature on the battlefield that shares at least one creature type with it. (For example, if two Goblin Warriors and a Goblin Shaman are on the battlefield, each gets +2/+2.)

* Sharing multiple creature types doesn't give an additional bonus. Coat of Arms counts creatures, not creature types.

Convalescence

{1}{W}

Enchantment

At the beginning of your upkeep, if you have 10 or less life, you gain 1 life.

* This ability has an "intervening 'if' clause." That means (1) the ability won't trigger at all unless you have 10 or less life, and (2) the ability will do nothing if you have 11 or more life by the time it resolves.

Crashing Boars

{3}{G}{G}

Creature -- Boar

4/4

Whenever Crashing Boars attacks, defending player chooses an untapped creature he or she controls. That creature blocks Crashing Boars this turn if able.

* The defending player doesn't choose an untapped creature he or she controls until the ability resolves. Once that player chooses a creature, it's too late for anyone to respond.

* If the defending player controls no untapped creatures at the time the ability resolves, the ability simply doesn't do anything.

* If, as the declare blockers step begins, the chosen creature is unable to block Crashing Boars for any reason, then it doesn't. This could happen if either the chosen creature or Crashing Boars gains an ability that would make the block illegal, the chosen creature is tapped, or some other ability prevents the chosen creature from blocking Crashing Boars. In that case, the chosen creature can block another creature or block no creature at all.

Cunning

{1}{U}

Enchantment -- Aura

Enchant creature

Enchanted creature gets +3/+3.

When enchanted creature attacks or blocks, sacrifice Cunning at the beginning of the next cleanup step.

* If the enchanted creature attacks or blocks, Cunning will be sacrificed during the cleanup step, not the end step. That means it'll be sacrificed after "until end of turn" abilities end and damage is removed from creatures. For example, if Cunning enchants a creature that's normally 2/2, and that creature is blocked by a 4/4, the enchanted creature will survive even after Cunning is sacrificed later in the turn.

Curiosity

{U}

Enchantment -- Aura

Enchant creature

Whenever enchanted creature deals damage to an opponent, you may draw a card.

* Curiosity's ability triggers when the enchanted creature deals damage to an opponent of Curiosity's controller, not when the enchanted creature deals damage to an opponent of its own controller. For example, if a Curiosity you control enchants a creature an opponent controls, the ability won't trigger when that creature deals damage to you.

Dauthi Jackal

{2}{B}

Creature -- Dauthi Hound

2/1

Shadow (This creature can block or be blocked by only creatures with shadow.)

{B}{B}, Sacrifice Dauthi Jackal: Destroy target blocking creature.

* The ability may be activated targeting any blocking creature, not necessarily a creature blocking Dauthi Jackal.

Death's Duet

{2}{B}

Sorcery

Return two target creature cards from your graveyard to your hand.

* You must target two creature cards in your graveyard as you cast Death's Duet. If you can't (because there's just one creature card in your graveyard, perhaps), you can't cast the spell.

Dizzying Gaze

{R}

Enchantment -- Aura

Enchant creature you control

{R}: Enchanted creature deals 1 damage to target creature with flying.

* Dizzying Gaze can enchant only a creature you control. If at any time the enchanted creature is controlled by another player, Dizzying Gaze is put into its owner's graveyard as a state-based action.

* Although the activated ability causes the enchanted creature to deal damage, it's an ability of the Aura, not of the creature. For example, the ability could still be activated if the enchanted creature were also enchanted with Arrest (which prohibits the creature's activated abilities from being activated).

Dominating Lich

{1}{U}{U}

Creature -- Lich

1/1

{1}{U}{U}, {T}: Dominating Lich loses this ability and becomes an Aura enchantment with enchant creature. Attach it to target creature. You may pay {U} to end this effect.

You control enchanted creature.

* If an attacking or blocking creature changes controllers, that creature is removed from combat. It neither deals nor is dealt combat damage.

* Gaining control of a creature due to Dominating Ligid's effect doesn't untap that creature.

* If you end the effect of Dominating Ligid's first ability (or it stops being attached to the enchanted creature for any other reason), the control-change effect ends immediately.

Elvish Berserker

{G}

Creature -- Elf Berserker

1/1

Whenever Elvish Berserker becomes blocked, it gets +1/+1 until end of turn for each creature blocking it.

* If Elvish Berserker becomes blocked, its ability triggers just once, no matter how many creatures block it.

* The ability counts the number of creatures blocking Elvish Berserker as it resolves.

Entropic Specter

{3}{B}{B}

Creature -- Specter Spirit

/

Flying

As Entropic Specter enters the battlefield, choose an opponent.

Entropic Specter's power and toughness are each equal to the number of cards in the chosen player's hand.

Whenever Entropic Specter deals damage to a player, that player discards a card.

* The last ability triggers whenever Entropic Specter deals any kind of damage to a player, not just combat damage.

Equilibrium

{1}{U}{U}

Enchantment

Whenever you cast a creature spell, you may pay {1}. If you do, return target creature to its owner's hand.

* You must target a creature as you put Equilibrium's triggered ability on the stack. You don't decide whether to pay {1} until the ability resolves.

Exalted Dragon

{4}{W}{W}

Creature -- Dragon

5/5

Flying

Exalted Dragon can't attack unless you sacrifice a land.

* Exalted Dragon's second ability is a cost to attack. It must be paid each time it attacks. This is in addition to any other costs to attack that may apply, such as the one from Ghostly Prison, for example.

Fade Away

{2}{U}

Sorcery

For each creature, its controller sacrifices a permanent unless he or she pays {1}.

* As Fade Away resolves, the player whose turn it is counts the number of creatures he or she controls, then, for each one, that player pays {1} or chooses a permanent to sacrifice. (For example, if that player controls three creatures, he or she may pay {3}, may pay {2} and choose a permanent to sacrifice, may pay {1} and choose two permanents to sacrifice, or may choose three permanents to sacrifice.) Then each other player in turn order does the same. Then all permanents chosen this way are sacrificed simultaneously.

* The permanents that are sacrificed this way don't have to be those creatures.

* Once Fade Away begins to resolve, the number of creatures a player controls is "locked in" before a player gets a chance to activate mana abilities. This makes a difference if activating a mana ability causes a creature to be sacrificed, such as Blood Pet or Wild Cantor, for example. If those creatures are sacrificed before Fade Away begins to resolve, however, they won't be counted by Fade Away's effect.

Fugue

{3}{B}{B}

Sorcery

Target player discards three cards.

* If the targeted player has fewer than three cards in his or her hand, that player discards all of them.

Furnace Brood

{3}{R}

Creature -- Elemental

3/3

{R}: Target creature can't be regenerated this turn.

* After this ability resolves, the affected creature may still be targeted by spells and abilities that regenerate it. Similarly, its activated abilities that regenerate it may still be activated. However, the regeneration shields that those spells and abilities create will have no effect.

Grollub
{2}{B}
Creature -- Beast
3/3
Whenever Grollub is dealt damage, each opponent gains that much life.

* Grollub's ability triggers whenever it's dealt any kind of damage, not just combat damage.

* If Grollub is dealt damage at the same time an opponent is dealt damage equal to or greater than his or her life total, that opponent will lose the game for having 0 life before Grollub's triggered ability resolves.

High Ground
{W}
Enchantment
Each creature you control can block an additional creature.

* High Ground's effect is cumulative. If you control a creature that can block an additional creature due to some other effect (including, perhaps, a second High Ground), High Ground will enable it to block a third creature.

* High Ground allows you to make some complicated blocks. For example, if you're being attacked by three creatures (call them A, B, and C) and you control three creatures (X, Y, and Z), you can have X block A and B, Y block B and C, and Z block just C, among many other possible options.

* The rules for dividing a blocking creature's combat damage among multiple blocked creatures are the same as the rules for dividing an attacking creature's combat damage among multiple blockers.
-- When the block is declared, a damage assignment order must be made for each blocking creature.
-- When combat damage is assigned, the blocking creature assigns its combat damage to the creatures it's blocking according to the damage assignment order announced for it. It can't assign combat damage to one of those creatures unless each creature that precedes that creature in its order is assigned lethal damage.
-- When checking for assigned lethal damage, take into account damage that's already been dealt to that creature, as well as damage from other creatures that's being assigned during the same combat damage step (even if it hasn't been assigned yet). However, ignore any other effects that would modify how damage is dealt (like protection abilities or prevention effects).
-- A player may choose to assign more than lethal damage to a creature.

Jackalope Herd
{3}{G}
Creature -- Rabbit Beast
4/5
When you cast a spell, return Jackalope Herd to its owner's hand.

* You return Jackalope Herd to its owner's hand only if it's still on the battlefield as its ability resolves.

Killer Whale

{3}{U}{U}

Creature -- Whale

3/5

{U}: Killer Whale gains flying until end of turn.

* To work as an evasion ability, an attacking Killer Whale must already have flying when the declare blockers step begins. Once it's become blocked, giving it flying won't change that.

Kor Chant

{2}{W}

Instant

All damage that would be dealt this turn to target creature you control by a source of your choice is dealt to another target creature instead.

* You choose both target creatures as you cast Kor Chant. You choose the source of damage as Kor Chant resolves.

* You must control the first targeted creature. It doesn't matter who controls the second targeted creature.

* Whether you control the first targeted creature is checked only as you cast Kor Chant and as it resolves. If another player gains control of that creature after that, Kor Chant's redirection effect will still apply to it.

* If the first targeted creature is no longer on the battlefield at the time the chosen source would deal damage to it, that damage is not dealt. It will not be redirected to the second creature.

* If the second targeted creature is no longer on the battlefield at the time the chosen source deals damage to the first targeted creature, that damage is not redirected. It will be dealt to the first creature.

* Redirecting damage doesn't change its source. In other words, the first targeted creature doesn't deal damage to the second targeted creature -- the original source of the damage does.

* If multiple prevention and/or replacement effects modify how damage would be dealt to a creature, its controller chooses the order to apply the effects. For example, if the first targeted creature has protection from red and would be dealt 2 damage by Pyroclasm, its controller may apply the protection effect (which prevents the damage) or the effect from Kor Chant (which redirects the damage). The other effect won't do anything, since the creature would no longer be dealt damage by the chosen source.

* If the damage that would be dealt to the first targeted creature is combat damage or unpreventable damage, it will still be combat damage or unpreventable damage after it has been redirected.

Limited Resources

{W}

Enchantment

When Limited Resources enters the battlefield, each player chooses five lands he or she controls and sacrifices the rest.

Players can't play lands as long as ten or more lands are on the battlefield.

* Players don't choose lands until the first ability resolves. Once a player chooses his or her lands, it's too late for anyone to respond.

* First the player whose turn it is chooses five lands he or she controls. (If that player controls fewer than five lands, that player chooses all lands he or she controls.) Then each other player in turn order does the same. Then all lands not chosen this way are sacrificed simultaneously.

Memory Crystal

{3}

Artifact

Buyback costs cost {2} less.

* Memory Crystal reduces only buyback costs, not total costs of spells cast with buyback. It reduces only the generic mana portions of buyback costs, and will reduce that cost as much as it can. For example, if you cast a spell that costs {2}{W} and has a buyback cost of {1}{W}, Memory Crystal will reduce the amount you pay for the buyback cost to {W}, but it won't affect any other costs. If you cast that spell with buyback, you'll pay {2}{W}{W}.

* The ability applies to all players.

* The cost reduction is not optional.

Mind Maggots

{3}{B}

Creature -- Insect

2/2

When Mind Maggots enters the battlefield, discard any number of creature cards. For each card discarded this way, put two +1/+1 counters on Mind Maggots.

* You may discard zero creature cards.

* Mind Maggots doesn't enter the battlefield with the +1/+1 counters already on it. It will be 2/2 until its ability resolves.

Mirozel

{3}{U}

Creature -- Illusion

2/3

Flying

When Mirozel becomes the target of a spell or ability, return Mirozel to its owner's hand.

* If Mirozel becomes the target of a spell or ability, Mirozel's ability triggers and is put on the stack on top of that spell or ability. Mirozel's ability will resolve (causing it to be returned to its owner's hand) first. Unless the spell or ability has another target, it will then be countered when it tries to resolve for having no legal targets.

Mogg Assassin

{2}{R}

Creature -- Goblin Assassin

2/1

{T}: You choose target creature an opponent controls, and that opponent chooses target creature. Flip a coin. If you win the flip, destroy the creature you chose. Otherwise, destroy the creature your opponent chose.

* The opponent may target any creature, not necessarily a creature you control. The opponent may even target the same creature that you did. (If there's only one creature on the battlefield that can be targeted, because Mogg Assassin has gained shroud for example, that's what the opponent will have to do.) If that happens, the targeted creature will be destroyed no matter what the result of the coin flip is.

* If two different creatures are targeted, and only one of them has become illegal by the time the ability resolves, the ability will still resolve. If the coin flip would cause the illegal target to be destroyed, nothing happens.

* Once the coin has been flipped, it's too late for players to respond. If a player wants to activate a regeneration ability of one of the targeted creatures, for example, he or she must do so before knowing whether that creature will be destroyed by the ability.

Monstrous Hound

{3}{R}

Creature -- Hound

4/4

Monstrous Hound can't attack unless you control more lands than defending player.

Monstrous Hound can't block unless you control more lands than attacking player.

* Once Monstrous Hound has been declared as an attacker or a blocker, changing the number of lands you or any other player controls won't change that.

* In a Two-Headed Giant game, Monstrous Hound can attack if, at the time you declare attackers, you control more lands than either individual player on the defending team.

* In a Two-Headed Giant game, Monstrous Hound can block if, at the time you declare blockers, you control more lands than either individual player on the attacking team.

Nausea
{1}{B}
Sorcery
All creatures get -1/-1 until end of turn.

* Nausea affects only creatures on the battlefield at the time it resolves. It won't affect creatures that enter the battlefield later in the turn.

Necrologia
{3}{B}{B}
Instant
Cast Necrologia only during your end step.
As an additional cost to cast Necrologia, pay X life.
Draw X cards.

* The end step (which is when you may cast Necrologia) occurs immediately before the cleanup step (which is when you must discard down to your maximum hand size).

Null Brooch
{4}
Artifact
{2}, {T}, Discard your hand: Counter target noncreature spell.

* You may activate Null Brooch's ability even if there are no cards in your hand.

Oath of Druids
{1}{G}
Enchantment
At the beginning of each player's upkeep, that player chooses target player who controls more creatures than he or she does and is his or her opponent. The first player may reveal cards from his or her library until he or she reveals a creature card. If he or she does, that player puts that card onto the battlefield and puts all other cards revealed this way into his or her graveyard.

* If the player whose turn it is chooses to reveal cards from the top of his or her library as the triggered ability resolves, but there are no creature cards left in that library, the player will reveal his or her entire library and put all of those cards into his or her graveyard.

Oath of Ghouls
{1}{B}
Enchantment

At the beginning of each player's upkeep, that player chooses target player whose graveyard has fewer creature cards in it than his or her graveyard does and is his or her opponent. The first player may return a creature card from his or her graveyard to his or her hand.

* The player whose turn it is doesn't choose a creature card in his or her graveyard until Oath of Ghouls's ability resolves. Once that player chooses a creature, it's too late for players to respond.

Oath of Scholars

{3}{U}

Enchantment

At the beginning of each player's upkeep, that player chooses target player who has more cards in hand than he or she does and is his or her opponent. The first player may discard his or her hand and draw three cards.

* The player whose turn it is may choose to discard his or her hand and draw three cards even if there are no cards in that player's hands.

Onslaught

{R}

Enchantment

Whenever you cast a creature spell, tap target creature.

* You may target a creature that's already tapped.

* The ability is mandatory. If no one else controls a creature when the ability triggers, you'll have to target one of your own and you'll have to tap it.

Pandemonium

{3}{R}

Enchantment

Whenever a creature enters the battlefield, that creature's controller may have it deal damage equal to its power to target creature or player of his or her choice.

* The ability is controlled by the player who controlled Pandemonium at the time the ability triggered. However, the player who controls the creature that entered the battlefield (and who thus caused the ability to trigger) is the one who chooses the target.

* If a creature with an "enters the battlefield" ability enters the battlefield, that ability and Pandemonium's ability both trigger. If the same player controls both permanents, that player chooses the order in which they'll resolve. If the player whose turn it is controls one of those permanents and another player controls the other, the ability controlled by the player whose turn it is resolves last.

* The creature's controller must choose a target as Pandemonium's ability is put on the stack. The player doesn't decide whether to have that creature deal damage until the ability resolves.

* Pandemonium's ability causes the creature that entered the battlefield to deal damage. Pandemonium itself deals no damage.

* The power of the creature that entered the battlefield is checked when Pandemonium resolves. If that creature is no longer on the battlefield, its last existence on the battlefield is checked to determine its power.

Paroxysm

{1}{R}

Enchantment -- Aura

Enchant creature

At the beginning of the upkeep of enchanted creature's controller, that player reveals the top card of his or her library. If that card is a land card, destroy that creature. Otherwise, it gets +3/+3 until end of turn.

* The revealed card remains on top of the player's library.

Pit Spawn

{4}{B}{B}{B}

Creature -- Demon

6/4

First strike

At the beginning of your upkeep, sacrifice Pit Spawn unless you pay {B}{B}.

Whenever Pit Spawn deals damage to a creature, exile that creature.

* The last ability triggers whenever Pit Spawn deals any kind of damage to a creature, not just combat damage.

* If Pit Spawn deals lethal damage to a creature, that creature is destroyed as a state-based action before Pit Spawn's last ability resolves. The creature is put into its owner's graveyard, not exiled.

Plaguebearer

{1}{B}

Creature -- Zombie

1/1

{X}{X}{B}: Destroy target nonblack creature with converted mana cost X.

* For example, if you target a nonblack creature with converted mana cost 3, the cost to activate the ability is {3}{3}{B}, or {6}{B}.

Pygmy Troll

{1}{G}

Creature -- Troll

1/1

Whenever Pygmy Troll becomes blocked, it gets +1/+1 until end of turn for each creature blocking it.

{G}: Regenerate Pygmy Troll.

* If Pygmy Troll becomes blocked, its ability triggers just once, no matter how many creatures block it.

* The ability counts the number of creatures blocking Pygmy Troll as it resolves.

Rabid Wolverines

{3}{G}{G}

Creature -- Wolverine

4/4

Whenever Rabid Wolverines becomes blocked, it gets +1/+1 until end of turn for each creature blocking it.

* If Rabid Wolverines becomes blocked, its ability triggers just once, no matter how many creatures block it.

* The ability counts the number of creatures blocking Rabid Wolverines as it resolves.

Ravenous Baboons

{3}{R}

Creature -- Ape

2/2

When Ravenous Baboons enters the battlefield, destroy target nonbasic land.

* The ability is mandatory. If no one else controls a nonbasic land when the ability triggers, you'll have to target one of your own and you'll have to destroy it.

Reckless Ogre

{3}{R}

Creature -- Ogre

3/2

Whenever Reckless Ogre attacks alone, it gets +3/+0 until end of turn.

* Reckless Ogre "attacks alone" if it's the only creature declared as an attacker in a given combat phase.

* If you attack with multiple creatures, but then all but Reckless Ogre are removed from combat, Reckless Ogre's ability won't trigger.

* If you attack with just Reckless Ogre, then an effect puts another creature onto the battlefield attacking, Reckless Ogre's ability will still trigger and resolve as normal.

* If an effect puts Reckless Ogre onto the battlefield attacking, its ability won't trigger since it was never declared as an attacker.

* In a Two-Headed Giant game, Reckless Ogre "attacks alone" if it's the only creature declared as an attacker by your entire team.

Reconnaissance

{W}

Enchantment

{0}: Remove target attacking creature you control from combat and untap it.

* You may target an untapped creature with this ability.

* A creature that's been removed from combat neither deals nor is dealt combat damage.

* You may target an attacking creature during the combat damage step (after combat damage has been dealt) or during the end of combat step, since it remains an attacking creature until the combat phase ends. Removing it from combat at this point won't have any particular effect other than making it cease to be an attacking creature (unless first strike or double strike is involved; see below), but the effect will untap it.

* You may target an attacking creature with first strike or double strike during the first combat damage step after it's dealt its combat damage. In that case, it will neither deal nor be dealt combat damage during the second combat damage step.

Recurring Nightmare

{2}{B}

Enchantment

Sacrifice a creature, Return Recurring Nightmare to its owner's hand: Return target creature card from your graveyard to the battlefield. Activate this ability only any time you could cast a sorcery.

* You choose targets before you pay activation costs, so you can't target the creature you sacrifice to activate Recurring Nightmare's ability.

Resuscitate

{1}{G}

Instant

Until end of turn, creatures you control gain "{1}: Regenerate this creature."

* Resuscitate affects only creatures you control at the time it resolves. It won't affect creatures that come under your control later in the turn.

Scare Tactics

{B}

Instant

Creatures you control get +1/+0 until end of turn.

* Scare Tactics affects only creatures you control at the time it resolves. It won't affect creatures that come under your control later in the turn.

Shackles

{2}{W}

Enchantment -- Aura

Enchant creature

Enchanted creature doesn't untap during its controller's untap step.

{W}: Return Shackles to its owner's hand.

* Shackles may target, and may enchant, an untapped creature. If it does, it will have no effect unless that creature becomes tapped somehow.

* Only Shackles's controller, not the enchanted creature's controller, can activate the last ability.

* If the creature Shackles is attached to leaves the battlefield, Shackles will be put into its owner's graveyard as a state-based action. This happens before you could activate the last ability to return it to your hand. The same is true if the creature Shackles is attached to stops being a creature, gains protection from white, or otherwise becomes illegal for Shackles to enchant. (This means that if you want to return Shackles to its owner's hand, you'll need to do so before the creature becomes illegal to enchant. You'll usually get a chance to do this in response to the spell, ability, or foreseeable combat damage that would make that happen.)

Shield Mate

{W}

Creature -- Human Soldier

1/1

Sacrifice Shield Mate: Target creature gets +0/+4 until end of turn.

* Shield Mate can't deal combat damage and be sacrificed to save another creature from being dealt lethal combat damage. Either you sacrifice it during the declare blockers step to give another creature +0/+4 (in which case Shield Mate won't deal combat damage, though any creature blocked by it remains blocked), or you wait until the combat damage step (in which case a creature that's been dealt lethal combat damage will already have been destroyed and can't be saved with the +0/+4 bonus).

* You may target Shield Mate with its own ability. However, since you have to sacrifice it to pay the activation cost, the ability will be countered for having no legal targets.

Skyshaper

{2}

Artifact

Sacrifice Skyshaper: Creatures you control gain flying until end of turn.

* Skyshaper's ability affects only creatures you control at the time it resolves. It won't affect creatures that come under your control later in the turn.

* To work as an evasion ability, an attacking creature must already have flying when the declare blockers step begins. Once it's become blocked, giving it flying won't change that.

Soltari Visionary

{1}{W}{W}

Creature -- Soltari Cleric

2/2

Shadow (This creature can block or be blocked by only creatures with shadow.)

Whenever Soltari Visionary deals damage to a player, destroy target enchantment that player controls.

* The last ability triggers whenever Soltari Visionary deals any kind of damage to a player, not just combat damage.

* The ability is mandatory. If the damaged player controls any enchantments, you'll have to target one and you'll have to destroy it.

Song of Serenity

{1}{G}

Enchantment

Creatures that are enchanted can't attack or block.

* Song of Serenity is not itself an Aura, and can't enchant a creature.

* Song of Serenity affects all creatures that are enchanted by Auras, including your own.

Spellbook

{0}

Artifact

You have no maximum hand size.

* If multiple effects modify your hand size, apply them in timestamp order. For example, if you put Null Profusion (an enchantment that says your maximum hand size is two) onto the battlefield and then put Spellbook onto the battlefield, you'll have no maximum hand size. However, if those permanents entered the battlefield in the opposite order, your maximum hand size would be two.

Sphere of Resistance

{2}

Artifact

Spells cost {1} more to cast.

* Sphere of Resistance affects all spells cast by all players, including you.

Spike Cannibal

{1}{B}{B}

Creature -- Spike

0/0

Spike Cannibal enters the battlefield with a +1/+1 counter on it.
When Spike Cannibal enters the battlefield, move all +1/+1 counters from all creatures onto it.

* Spike Cannibal's second ability won't affect its own counter; that one just stays put.

* If Spike Cannibal is no longer on the battlefield by the time its second ability resolves, no counters will move because there's nowhere for them to move to. They'll remain wherever they are.

Spike Hatcher

{6}{G}

Creature -- Spike

0/0

Spike Hatcher enters the battlefield with six +1/+1 counters on it.
{2}, Remove a +1/+1 counter from Spike Hatcher: Put a +1/+1 counter on target creature.

{1}, Remove a +1/+1 counter from Spike Hatcher: Regenerate Spike Hatcher.

* If Spike Hatcher's last +1/+1 counter is removed to activate its last ability (and no other effect is boosting its toughness), it will not regenerate -- rather, it will be put into its owner's graveyard for having 0 toughness as a state-based action.

Thalakos Drifters

{2}{U}{U}

Creature -- Thalakos

3/3

Discard a card: Thalakos Drifters gains shadow until end of turn. (This creature can block or be blocked by only creatures with shadow.)

* Once Thalakos Drifters blocks or becomes blocked, causing it to gain shadow won't have any effect that combat. This ability can preclude blocks if it's activated before the declare blockers step, but it can't undo blocks that have already been declared.

Thopter Squadron

{5}

Artifact Creature -- Thopter

0/0

Flying

Thopter Squadron enters the battlefield with three +1/+1 counters on it.

{1}, Remove a +1/+1 counter from Thopter Squadron: Put a 1/1 colorless Thopter artifact creature token with flying onto the battlefield.

Activate this ability only any time you could cast a sorcery.

{1}, Sacrifice another Thopter: Put a +1/+1 counter on Thopter Squadron. Activate this ability only any time you could cast a sorcery.

* You may sacrifice any other Thopter to activate Thopter Squadron's last ability, not just a Thopter token created by its third ability.

* Another Thopter you control can't deal combat damage and be sacrificed to save Thopter Squadron from being dealt lethal combat damage. Either you sacrifice it during the declare blockers step to put a +1/+1 counter on Thopter Squadron (in which case the other Thopter won't deal combat damage, though any creature blocked by it remains blocked), or you wait until the combat damage step (in which case a Thopter Squadron that's been dealt lethal combat damage will already have been destroyed and can't be saved with the +1/+1 counter).

Transmogrifying Ligid

{3}

Artifact Creature -- Ligid

2/2

{1}, {T}: Transmogrifying Ligid loses this ability and becomes an Aura enchantment with enchant creature. Attach it to target creature. You may pay {1} to end this effect.

Enchanted creature gets +1/+1 and is an artifact in addition to its other types.

* After you activate Transmogrifying Ligid's first ability, it's just an enchantment with the subtype Aura. Even though it's colorless, it's no longer an artifact (just as it's no longer a creature).

* On the other hand, the enchanted creature doesn't lose any of its card types or subtypes. It becomes an artifact in addition to them.

Volrath's Dungeon

{2}{B}{B}

Enchantment

Pay 5 life: Destroy Volrath's Dungeon. Any player may activate this ability but only during his or her turn.

Discard a card: Target player puts a card from his or her hand on top of his or her library. Activate this ability only any time you could cast a sorcery.

* Any player may activate Volrath's Dungeon's first ability. Only the controller of Volrath's Dungeon may activate its second ability.

* Although Volrath's Dungeon's first ability may be activated only by the player whose turn it is, that player may do so any time he or she could cast an instant (as opposed to the second ability, which may be activated only any time Volrath's Dungeon's controller could cast a sorcery).

Wall of Nets

{1}{W}{W}

Creature -- Wall

0/7

Defender (*This creature can't attack.*)

At end of combat, exile all creatures blocked by Wall of Nets.

When Wall of Nets leaves the battlefield, return all cards exiled with Wall of Nets to the battlefield under their owners' control.

* Wall of Nets's second ability triggers only if it's still on the battlefield when the end of combat step begins (after the combat damage step). For example, if it blocks a 7/7 creature and is destroyed, its ability won't trigger at all. The 7/7 will remain on the battlefield.

* The second ability will exile all creatures it's currently blocking, not necessarily the creatures it had blocked during that combat phase. For example, if Wall of Nets is dealt lethal combat damage and regenerates, it's removed from combat. Its ability will trigger at end of combat, but since it's no longer blocking any creatures, the ability won't do anything.

* The third ability will return to the battlefield only the cards exiled with the second ability. It doesn't matter if they're creature cards. (For example, if Wall of Nets exiles an animated Stalking Stones, the third ability will return the Stalking Stones card to the battlefield.)

* If Wall of Nets leaves the battlefield before its second ability has resolved, its third ability will trigger and resolve, returning to the battlefield all cards that had previously been exiled with its second ability. Then its second ability will resolve and forever exile the creatures that were being blocked by Wall of Nets at the time it left the battlefield.

Whiptongue Frog

{2}{U}

Creature -- Frog

1/3

{U}: Whiptongue Frog gains flying until end of turn.

* To work as an evasion ability, an attacking Whiptongue Frog must already have flying when the declare blockers step begins. Once it's become blocked, giving it flying won't change that.

Wood Elves

{2}{G}

Creature -- Elf Scout

1/1

When Wood Elves enters the battlefield, search your library for a Forest card and put that card onto the battlefield. Then shuffle your library.

* Although the search is mandatory, you don't need to find a Forest card from your library if you don't want to. However, you must still shuffle your library.

* This ability lets you search for any card in your library with the land type Forest, not the name Forest. The card you find doesn't have to be a basic land.

Zealots en-Dal

{3}{W}

Creature -- Human Soldier

2/4

At the beginning of your upkeep, if all nonland permanents you control are white, you gain 1 life.

* This ability has an "intervening 'if' clause." That means (1) the ability won't trigger at all unless all nonland permanents you control are white, and (2) the ability will do nothing if you control any nonwhite permanents (other than lands) by the time it resolves.

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